Lullberry

Aging Well

21 practices and ideas from the best books on aging well

Week 1

1 **Honor your body's journey**

Start with gratitude for your body and the life it has enabled you to live.

"Cherish your body; it is yours for this one time only." Jack Kornfield, After the Ecstasy, the Laundry

2 **Rest to restore**

Deep, regular sleep helps protect memory, immune health, and mood. Create a calming pre-sleep ritual and aim for 7 to 8 hours each night.

"Just like exercise, sleep is its own kind of wonder drug." Peter Attia, Outlive

3 **Nourish from within**

Lean toward whole foods linked to slower cellular aging: leafy greens, berries, olive oil, nuts. Drink plenty of water.

"The best approximation for an anti-wrinkle diet is one that's centered around whole plant foods." Michael Greger, How Not to Age

4 **Move your body joyfully**

Walk, stretch, or dance each day, not to fix your body, but to enjoy living in it.

"Embrace the reality that movement is as important as brushing your teeth." Gabrielle Lyon, Forever Strong

5 **Rethink aging**

Replace 'getting old' with 'growing wise'. Seeing aging as a time of expansion, not decline, lifts your well-being.

"Even if we are the product of the past, we are still the architects of our future." Matthieu Ricard, Beyond the Self

6 **Declutter your space and mind**

Clear physical and mental clutter to reduce stress. Let go of what no longer serves you, from outdated beliefs to unused possessions.

"We don't need to believe everything our thoughts tell us." Elizabeth Blackburn, The Telomere Effect

7 **Build and keep your strength**

Add two short strength sessions this week: bodyweight, bands, or weights all count. Strength isn't about how you look: it's what keeps you independent as you age.

"The currency of healthy aging is muscle—lean, high-performance muscle." Mark Hyman, Young Forever

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Week 2

8 Cultivate emotional agility

Practice noticing your emotions without being ruled by them. This flexibility supports your mental health and gentler relationships.

"The aim is not to cease to experience emotions but to avoid being enslaved by them." Matthieu Ricard, Beyond the Self

9 Embrace imperfection

Talk to yourself as you would to a friend. Be gentle with your inner critic: a harsh inner voice can weigh on you more than the years.

"The point is not to perfect yourself. It is to perfect your love." Jack Kornfield, No Time Like the Present

10 Laugh and lighten up

Watch something funny, recall a ridiculous memory, or laugh with a friend. Lightness is medicine.

"Add humor, hugs, and laughter." Linda Bacon, Body Respect

11 Accept what is

Notice resistance to change. Practice softening around it. Acceptance isn't resignation: it's clarity.

"Hell is resistance. Heaven is acceptance." Stephen Levine, Who Dies?

12 Nurture a soul practice

Journal, pray, chant, or sit in nature. Caring for your soul deepens resilience and joy as you age.

"Life purpose is what brings us eudaemonic happiness, the healthy feeling that we are involved in something bigger than ourselves." Elizabeth Blackburn, The Telomere Effect

13 Tend to your daily rhythm

Choose one small part of your day to improve: how you eat, move, rest, or connect. Small shifts, big ripples.

"There is always a step small enough from where we are to get us to where we want to be." Ellen Langer, Counterclockwise

14 Strengthen true connection

Reach out and let yourself be vulnerable. Share a story. Be seen and heard. Aging well includes loving well.

"Evidently, a loving brain lives a happier and longer life." Lisa Mosconi, Brain Food

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Week 3

15 Cultivate presence

Take 10 to 15 minutes to simply sit and observe your breath, thoughts, and feelings without judgment. Eat one mindful meal today without distractions.

"The present moment is filled with joy and happiness. If you are attentive, you will see it." Thich Nhat Hanh, Peace Is Every Step

16 Express yourself creatively

Write, paint, play, or dance. Creative play is food for the soul and mind.

"Pen your poem, dance your dance, express the depths of your own heart." Jack Kornfield, No Time Like the Present

17 Share your wisdom

Mentor, volunteer, or simply tell stories. Your legacy takes shape in how you show up, starting today.

"I'm holding on to my torch. I'll let other people light theirs from mine." Daniel Levitin, Successful Aging

18 Keep learning, keep growing

Curiosity is youthfulness in disguise. Try or learn one new thing today: a language, an instrument, a skill. Your brain keeps its power to learn far longer than we think.

"You are never too old to set another goal or to dream a new dream." L. Brown in Mark Hyman, Young Forever

19 Practice forgiveness

Identify one grudge or resentment you're holding. Take a first step toward forgiveness, not for the other person, but for your own freedom and peace.

"Every day I make mistakes, and every day I try to forgive myself for them." Peter Attia, Outlive

20 Connect with nature

Spend 20 minutes outdoors mindfully: walk in a park, sit by water, or garden. Time in nature reduces stress and supports well-being.

"Don't hold yourself captive; get out there and bathe in nature!" Max Lugavere, The Genius Life

21 Accept the limits

Some things about growing older can only be met with grace: less speed, less energy, less certainty. The aging body, the slower pace. This is memento mori.

"We need to learn to see our physical form as a river. Our body is not a static thing—it changes all the time." Thich Nhat Hanh, You Are Here

Make it your practice

Feel, do or reflect: find the practices that fit you.

Week 1	Feel	Do	Reflect
1 Honor your body's journey	Place a hand on your heart and silently thank your body for carrying you this far. Write a short thank-you letter to your body, naming three moments it showed strength.	Look at yourself in the mirror and say one kind thing about a part of your body. Create a small ritual after showers to oil your skin and honor its resilience.	Reflect on 3 major life events and how your body supported you through them. Draw a timeline of your body's journey: injuries, achievements, changes, and what each taught you.
2 Rest to restore	Dim the lights or light a candle an hour before bed and let the day soften. Make a bedtime playlist that calms you deeply and use it all week.	Put your phone away 30 mins before bed tonight. Design a full wind-down routine: warm bath, herbal tea, no screens, 10pm sleep.	Read about sleep cycles and the link between aging and deep sleep. Track your sleep for 14 days and analyze your patterns.
3 Nourish from within	Sip a warm herbal tea slowly, feeling it nourish you. Before each meal today, pause for a small thank-you.	Eat a handful of nuts or berries instead of chips today. Plan a week of whole-food meals built around seasonal vegetables.	Read about how Mediterranean diets slow cognitive decline. Study Blue Zones' dietary habits and create a food journal to apply them.
4 Move your body joyfully	Put on your favorite song and sway gently for 2 minutes. Dance alone for 10 minutes to music that lifts your spirit.	Do 5 minutes of gentle stretching this morning. Take a dance, yoga, or movement class just for fun, not fitness.	Remember a way of moving you loved as a child. Could it come back? After a week of joyful movement, write down how your mood and energy have shifted.
5 Rethink aging	Say out loud: "I'm growing wiser, not older." Notice how it feels. Collect 3 quotes that celebrate aging and place them where you'll see them.	Replace the word "old" with "wise" in your self-talk for one day. Make a vision board showing what you want from the next decade.	List myths about aging and contrast them with research-backed truths. Write a page about how you'd like to see your own aging from now on.
6 Declutter your space and mind	Close your eyes for 2 minutes and let go of one old belief with each out-breath. Picture your worries as clouds and watch them drift away.	Clear one drawer or surface you use daily. Declutter one small area each day for a week, at home or in your calendar.	Make a list of beliefs you've outgrown and why. Draw a mind map of what fills your head; choose three things to let go of on purpose.
7 Build and keep your strength	Next time you stand up from a chair, notice the strength in your legs. Do a set of squats and feel the quiet pride of muscles at work.	Do 10 bodyweight squats or wall push-ups right now. Start a twice-weekly strength routine: squats, push-ups, rows, and a plank.	Think of one daily task that would get easier if you were stronger. Look up strength guidelines for your age and sketch a 4-week plan.

Make it your practice

Week 2	Feel	Do	Reflect
8 Cultivate emotional agility	Name what you're feeling right now, without judging it. Track your emotions daily for a week to notice patterns.	Take 3 deep breaths when upset before reacting. Try the RAIN method (Recognize, Allow, Investigate, Nurture) during a strong emotion.	Write about a recent emotional reaction: where might it have come from? Study Susan David's work and apply her "show up, step out, walk your why" process.
9 Embrace imperfection	When you make a mistake, whisper: "It's okay, you're doing your best." Write a letter from your inner critic, then answer it with kindness.	Place a hand on your heart whenever a self-critical thought arises. Listen to a self-compassion meditation before bed every night for a week.	Write down one harsh thing you often tell yourself, then rewrite it gently. Take Kristin Neff's free self-compassion test and reflect on your results.
10 Laugh and lighten up	Watch a short funny animal video. Let yourself giggle. Share an embarrassing memory with a trusted friend and laugh together.	Make a silly face at yourself in the mirror. Attend a live comedy night or improv class.	Remember a time humor helped you through something hard. Keep a funny journal for a week: one laugh a day.
11 Accept what is	When discomfort comes, say softly: "This too belongs." Sit for 5 minutes with an uncomfortable truth, without trying to fix it.	Write down what you're resisting today, then tear up the paper. For 3 days, notice and name each moment of resistance, without acting on it.	What is the difference between giving up and accepting? Write a short dialogue between the part of you that resists and the part that accepts.
12 Nurture a soul practice	Sit under a tree for 5 minutes, doing nothing. Pray, chant or sit in silence for 10 minutes each morning for a week.	Light a candle and write down 3 thoughts from your soul. Build a mini sacred space in your room with items that calm you.	What does "soul" mean to you, and when do you feel close to it? Start a soul journal: each evening, one moment that felt meaningful.
13 Tend to your daily rhythm	Notice when in the day you feel most alive. Track your daily highs and lows for one week and adjust your routine.	Shift one habit: walk after lunch or eat dinner earlier. Draw your ideal day, balancing energy, rest and connection, and live it for 3 days.	When does your energy dip today? What came just before? Study circadian rhythms and optimize your schedule accordingly.
14 Strengthen true connection	Text someone: "Thinking of you. Grateful you're in my life." Share a recent struggle with someone you feel safe with.	Schedule a 10-min call with a friend you haven't talked to in a while. Initiate a monthly "truth dinner" with a friend: phones off, deep talk.	With whom do you hold back, and why? Read Brené Brown's work and outline what real connection means for you.

Make it your practice

Week 3	Feel	Do	Reflect
15 Cultivate presence	Eat one grape slowly and attentively, noticing every detail. Walk in silence for 15 minutes, noticing sensations and thoughts.	Set a 5-minute timer and simply follow your breath. Take a full mindful meal: no phone, no conversation, just you and the food.	Read Thich Nhat Hanh's "How to Eat" or "The Miracle of Mindfulness." Keep a presence log for a week: what brought you into the now, what pulled you away.
16 Express yourself creatively	Doodle freely for 5 minutes, without judging. Spend 30 minutes on a creative project you've long ignored.	Write one haiku about your day. Sign up for a creative workshop: painting, photography, pottery.	How has your creativity changed over the years? Plan 30 days of small creative acts, one a day.
17 Share your wisdom	Tell a story from your past to someone younger. Write a letter of advice to your 25-year-old self and share it.	Offer a helpful tip to someone facing something you've been through. Start mentoring someone in your field or life path.	List the key lessons life has taught you. Build a "wisdom map" of lessons, stories and images you'd like to pass on.
18 Keep learning, keep growing	Read 2 pages from a new book or article. Join a local language, dance, or pottery class.	Try a new recipe or game this week. Set a goal to learn one new thing a month and track it.	Research the brain's ability to learn later in life. Design a 3-month learning plan around a passion you've ignored.
19 Practice forgiveness	Say softly: "I am willing to forgive." Notice any tension. Write a letter to someone you haven't forgiven (no need to send it).	Take a deep breath each time bitterness rises. Try the Ho'oponopono forgiveness mantra daily for 2 weeks.	How has holding on affected your peace of mind? Read about the science of forgiveness and how it affects health and aging.
20 Connect with nature	Sit by an open window or on your balcony and feel the breeze. Take a mindful walk barefoot in the grass or on a forest path.	Water a plant slowly, feeling each motion. Plan a weekend day in nature: hike, picnic, or silent forest walk.	Recall a place in nature where you felt at peace. What made it so? After each time outdoors this week, write a few lines about how you feel.
21 Accept the limits	Sit quietly for 2 minutes and say: "I am allowed to slow down." Notice what softens. Write a thank-you and farewell to something your younger body could do.	Do one everyday task today at half your usual speed, on purpose. Adjust one routine to fit your energy now (a shorter walk, an earlier night) and keep it for a week.	Reflect on one limit that has brought you an unexpected gift. Read about memento mori or impermanence and write what a good old age means to you.